

Name: _____

Period: _____

Date: _____

Topic 2.6 Guided Notes: Retrieving Memories

Unit 2: Cognition | AP Psychology

Directions: Read through the topic overview page below and fill in each blank as you go. Use the tables and activities to check your understanding, then head to the quiz link at the end to test yourself.

Source page: appspsychreviewhub.com/overviews/topic2.6

Word Bank

<i>Recall</i>	<i>Retrieval Cues</i>	<i>Retrieval Practice</i>
<i>Context-Dependent Memory</i>	<i>The Testing Effect</i>	<i>Mood-Congruent Memory</i>
<i>Retrieval</i>	<i>Metacognition</i>	<i>Recognition</i>
<i>State-Dependent Memory</i>		

1. How We Pull It Out: Recall vs. Recognition

Getting information back out of storage is called _____, and it's heavily influenced by the _____ (hints or triggers) available to you.

- _____: retrieving previously learned information without much external help — like a fill-in-the-blank test with no word bank. You have to generate the answer entirely from your own memory.
- _____: identifying previously learned information from a set of options — like a multiple-choice test. Because the correct answer is sitting right in front of you, this is a much easier process than recall.

Apply It: Recall or Recognition?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	Asked to describe a robbery suspect's face in detail to a police sketch artist with no photos to reference, a witness must generate the image entirely from her own memory.	
2	Shown a photo lineup of six people, a witness immediately points to the one she remembers seeing at the scene.	

2. The Power of Being There: State and Context

Retrieval cues aren't just external hints — the actual physical environment and even your own internal state at the moment of learning can become woven into a memory.

- _____: recall is often better when you are in the same external physical environment (the same room, the same location) as when you first encoded the memory.
- _____: recall is often better when you are in the same internal, physiological state (the same level of caffeine, the same level of intoxication) as when you first encoded the memory.

- _____: a specific type of state-dependent memory tied to emotions. Your current mood acts like a magnet, making it much easier to recall other memories that match that same emotional tone (e.g., feeling sad makes other sad memories more accessible).

Apply It: Which Retrieval Cue?

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A student who studied for her final exam in the same classroom she will take the test in finds the familiar room actually helps her remember the material better.	
2	A man who is in an unusually cheerful mood finds that happy memories from his past come to mind far more easily than usual.	

3. Thinking About Thinking: Study Hacks

_____ is your awareness and understanding of your own thought processes — essentially, thinking about your own thinking. It's what allows you to honestly judge whether you actually know something or just think you do.

One of the best study strategies to come out of memory research is _____ — actively quizzing yourself on material (like with flashcards) instead of just passively rereading your notes. Decades of research confirm _____: self-testing dramatically improves long-term retention compared to simple rereading, because the act of retrieval itself strengthens the memory.

4. Don't Trip Up! (Common Misconceptions)

If you're picking from options (like a multiple-choice test or a police lineup), that's _____. If you have to generate the answer completely from scratch (like an essay question or a sketch artist), that's _____.

_____ is about your outside environment (the room you're in). _____ is about your inside body (your mood, your caffeine level, your physiological arousal).

5. Quick Check: Review Questions

Circle the best answer for each question below.

1. Taking a fill-in-the-blank test with no word bank provided, a student must generate each vocabulary term entirely from her own memory, without any answer choices to jog her recognition. This type of retrieval is called:

- A. Recognition
- B. Recall
- C. State-Dependent Memory
- D. Mood-Congruent Memory

2. A student takes a multiple-choice exam and finds that seeing the four possible answer choices printed on the page makes it much easier to identify the correct one than if she had to write the answer from memory alone. This easier retrieval process is called:
- A. Context-Dependent Memory
 - B. Recognition
 - C. Metacognition
 - D. Recall
3. A student who drank three cups of coffee while studying for her exam finds she actually performs better on the test if she also has caffeine in her system during the exam itself, since her brain encoded the vocabulary alongside that internal caffeine rush. This phenomenon is called:
- A. Recognition
 - B. Context-Dependent Memory
 - C. State-Dependent Memory
 - D. Mood-Congruent Memory
4. While feeling deeply sad after a difficult breakup, a woman finds that her mind keeps drifting toward every other embarrassing or depressing memory from her past, almost as if her current emotion is a magnet attracting only similarly toned memories. This specific type of state-dependent memory is called:
- A. Recall
 - B. Metacognition
 - C. Context-Dependent Memory
 - D. Mood-Congruent Memory
5. A researcher finds that students who actively quiz themselves on course material score significantly higher on a final exam than students who spend the exact same amount of time simply rereading their notes. This scientifically proven finding, that active self-testing improves long-term memory more than passive rereading, is called:
- A. The Spacing Effect
 - B. The Testing Effect
 - C. Metacognition
 - D. Retrieval Practice



Check Your Progress

Done with your notes? Head over to the [Quiz](https://appspsychreviewhub.com/quiz) to test what you've learned:

<https://appspsychreviewhub.com/quiz>